ZikShare

ACADEMIC VAULT

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# Cybersecurity and Online Safety: Protect Your Accounts, Data and Future

Practical account security, phishing defence and the legal risks of cybercrime

DIGITAL SKILLS

## Digital Skills

General Studies (GST / CED)
GST Directorate | 100L

**Written for students, by students.**

Practical notes, worked examples, practice questions and a revision plan.

Study smarter. Ask better questions. Pass with understanding.

Independent study support | Not an official UNIZIK publication

START HERE

# Why this pack exists

Students are targeted because they hold bank details, social accounts and personal data with limited security habits. This pack covers strong authentication, phishing recognition, device hygiene and the Nigerian legal consequences of offences such as identity theft and unauthorised access.

This is a student-written study companion, not a reproduced lecture handout or a leaked examination paper. Use it to organise the topics you are taught, practise the kind of thinking your course rewards, and walk into class with better questions.

## What you will be able to do

- Secure accounts with strong passwords and two-factor authentication.
- Recognise phishing messages and verify links before clicking.
- Apply device and data hygiene practices.
- Explain the legal consequences of common cybercrimes in Nigeria.

## How to use this pack

1. Skim the whole pack once in 20 minutes so you know what is inside.
2. Work through one section at a time with your lecture note and recommended text beside you.
3. Attempt the practice questions before reading the answers. Mark what you missed.
4. Use the final checklist to plan your revision week, one tick per study session.

> **Confirm your official course outline**
> Course codes, credit units and outlines can differ by department and session. Treat this pack as supplementary support and confirm the current outline with your lecturer, course rep or departmental handbook before an assessment.

## Account security

Most account compromise comes from reused passwords and social engineering, not sophisticated hacking.

- Use a unique passphrase for every important account.
- Enable two-factor authentication, preferably an authenticator app over SMS.
- Never share one-time passwords, even with someone claiming to be support.
- Review connected apps and revoke access you do not recognise.
- Lock your phone and laptop with a PIN or biometric, and encrypt if available.
- Log out of shared computers and never save passwords on public devices.

## Phishing and social engineering

Attackers persuade; they rarely need to break in.

- Check the sender address, not just the display name.
- Hover over links to see the real destination before clicking.
- Be suspicious of urgency, threats, and requests for codes or payments.
- Verify unusual requests through a second channel you initiate.
- Treat attachments from unknown senders as dangerous.
- Report phishing to the platform and delete it; do not forward it.

> **The OTP rule**
> No bank, university or platform will ask for your OTP. Anyone who does is committing fraud, regardless of how official they sound.

## Device hygiene and the law

Digital habits have legal and reputational consequences.

- Update operating systems and apps; updates patch known vulnerabilities.
- Back up important files to two locations.
- Avoid cracked software, which often carries malware.
- Do not use another person's credentials or access systems without authorisation.
- Under the Cybercrimes Act, offences include unauthorised access, identity theft, cyberstalking and phishing, with serious penalties.
- Online behaviour is permanent; screenshots and logs outlive deletion.

PRACTICE, NOT PREDICTION

## Check your understanding

These questions are written for this pack to test the ideas above. They are not past examination questions and do not predict what your lecturer will set. Answer first, then compare.

1. Why is two-factor authentication important?

Answer: It adds a second verification step, so a stolen password alone is not enough to access the account.

2. Give three signs of a phishing message.

Answer: Urgency, a mismatched sender or link, and a request for credentials, codes or payment.

3. What should you do if you receive an OTP request from someone claiming to be a bank officer?

Answer: Refuse, hang up, and contact the bank through its official number.

4. Name two offences under Nigerian cybercrime law.

Answer: Unauthorised access to a computer system and identity theft; phishing and cyberstalking are also offences.

5. Why avoid cracked software?

Answer: It frequently contains malware and has no security updates, exposing your accounts and files.

## Your 7-step action plan

Tick each step only when you have done it. A tick you cannot defend is worse than an empty box.

- [ ] Set unique passwords for your email, bank and school portal.
- [ ] Enable two-factor authentication on email and social accounts.
- [ ] Review connected apps and revoke unfamiliar access.
- [ ] Check three links by hovering before clicking.
- [ ] Update your phone, laptop and key apps.
- [ ] Back up essential files to a second location.
- [ ] Read a summary of the Cybercrimes Act and note three offences.

## Keep going

One pack will not carry a semester. Pair this with your lecture notes, tutorials, and the past questions your department actually releases. If a topic still feels unclear, take a specific question to your lecturer or course rep - "I do not understand the difference between X and Y" gets a better answer than "I do not understand this course".

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YOUR WORKSPACE

# Notes, questions and things to ask

Use this page in class or during revision. Write questions you could not answer instead of copying slides.

**Three ideas I can now explain without notes:**

**A question I still cannot answer:**

**For my lecturer or course rep:**

**Next revision action and date:**

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